12.9.3 Concept of Disease and Cause

When the normal equilibrium of three humors (*vatha*, *pitha* and *kapha*) is disturbed, disease is caused. The factors, which affect this equilibrium are environment, climatic conditions, diet, physical activities, and stress. Under normal conditions, the ratio between these three humors (vatha, pitha and kapha) is 4:2:1 respectively.

According to the Siddha medicine system diet and life style play a major role not only in health but also in curing diseases. This concept of the Siddha medicine is termed as *pathya* and *apathya*, which is essentially a list of do's and don'ts.

12.9.4 Diagnosis

In diagnosis, examination of eight items is required which is commonly known as *astasthana-pariksa*. These are:

- *na* (tongue): black in vatha, yellow or red in pitha, white in kapha, ulcerated in anaemia.
- *varna* (colour): dark in vatha, yellow or red in pitha, pale in kapha;
- *svara* (voice): normal in vatha, high pitched in pitha, low pitched in kapha, slurred in alcoholism.
- *kan* (eyes): muddy conjunctiva, yellowish or red in pitha, pale in kapha.
- *sparisam* (touch): dry in vatha, warm in pitha, chill in kapha, sweating in different parts of the body.
- *mala* (stool): black stools indicate *vatha*, yellow *pitha*, pale in *kapha*, dark red in ulcer and shiny in terminal illness.
- *neer* (urine): early morning urine is examined; straw colour indicates indigestion, reddish yellow excessive heat, rose in blood pressure, saffron colour in jaundice and looks like meat washed water in renal disease.
- *nadi* (pulse): the confirmatory method recorded on the radial artery.

Sl. No		Vadam	Pitham	Kabam
1.	Na(tongue)	Black	Yellow	White
2.	Varnam(Colour)	Dark	Red	Pale
3.	Kural(Voice)	Normal	High Pitch	Low
4.	Kan(eyes)	Muddy	Red	Pale
5.	Thodal(touch)	Dry	Warm	Chill
6.	Malam(stool)	Black	Yellow	Pale
7.	Neer(Urine)	Straw(Indigestion)	Red(Heat)	Saffron(Jaundice)
8.	Naadi(Pulse)	Confirmatory method recorded on the radial artery.		

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